

Journal Publishing System — Weekly Progress Report

Government College University Faisalabad

Department of Software Engineering

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering

Journal Publishing System

Research Paper Submission and Review Management Platform

Report Information

Field	Details
Report Date	18 May 2026
Reporting Period	12 May 2026 — 18 May 2026
Current Phase	Phase 4 — Frontend & Backend Integration
Overall Status	In Progress
Supervisor	To Be Updated
Session	2022 – 2026

Team Member

Name	Registration No.
Emaan Ajmal	2022-GCUF-XXXXX

1. Project Overview

The Journal Publishing System is a web-based platform designed to manage the complete workflow of academic journal publishing. The system provides separate modules for Authors, Reviewers, Editors, and

Administrators. Authors can submit research papers, reviewers can evaluate submissions, and editors can manage publication decisions.

The project is being developed using the MERN Stack (MongoDB, Express.js, React.js, Node.js). The platform includes authentication, role-based dashboards, journal submission management, file uploads, paper review workflows, and admin management features.

This weekly report covers the progress made during the frontend-backend integration phase, API testing, authentication debugging, database configuration, and deployment preparation.

2. Weekly Progress Summary

Component	Summary	Status
Frontend Development	React frontend structure reviewed and aligned with backend APIs.	In Progress
Backend Development	Node.js and Express backend configured with MongoDB integration.	In Progress
Authentication System	JWT-based authentication implementation reviewed and tested.	In Progress
Database Integration	MongoDB Atlas connection configured successfully.	Complete
Cloudinary Integration	Cloudinary environment variables and upload configuration added.	Complete
API Testing	Registration and authentication APIs tested using frontend and Postman.	In Progress
Error Debugging	Fixed multiple server and integration errors during testing.	In Progress
Deployment Preparation	Project structure reviewed for deployment readiness.	Pending

3. Completed Work

3.1 Frontend and Backend Repository Review

The frontend and backend repositories of the Journal Publishing System were reviewed and analyzed to ensure compatibility between frontend requests and backend API routes.

Completed tasks:

1. Reviewed frontend folder structure and component organization
2. Reviewed backend Express.js architecture and middleware setup
3. Verified API route paths and frontend request URLs
4. Checked environment variable configurations
5. Confirmed role-based routing structure

Repository modules analyzed:

- Authentication module
- Author dashboard
- Journal submission module
- Admin panel
- Reviewer management module
- File upload handling

3.2 MongoDB Database Configuration

MongoDB Atlas database integration was configured successfully using environment variables.

Database Configuration Details

Component	Details
Database	MongoDB Atlas
Backend Framework	Node.js + Express.js
ODM	Mongoose
Authentication	JWT
Environment Variables	Configured in .env

Configured environment variables:

- MONGO_URI
- JWT_SECRET
- CLOUD_NAME
- API_KEY
- API_SECRET

The backend server successfully connected to MongoDB after resolving configuration issues.

3.3 Authentication System Testing

The authentication module was tested for user registration and login functionality.

Implemented and tested features:

1. User registration API
2. Login authentication API
3. JWT token generation
4. Role-based user registration
5. Password handling
6. Middleware token verification

Authentication Workflow

1. User submits registration form
2. Backend validates input fields
3. User data stored in MongoDB
4. JWT token generated after login
5. Protected routes verified using middleware

During testing, API request and token-related issues were identified and partially resolved.

3.4 Cloudinary Configuration

Cloudinary was configured for handling file and image uploads within the Journal Publishing System.

Cloudinary Integration Details

Component	Purpose
Cloudinary	File and document upload management
API Integration	Upload handling from frontend
Environment Variables	Configured securely

The Cloudinary setup was connected with backend services for future paper and document upload functionality.

3.5 Backend Server Debugging

Several backend runtime issues were identified and debugged during development.

Resolved issues:

1. MongoDB connection problems
2. Missing environment variable errors
3. JWT decoding issues
4. Server startup problems
5. API route configuration mismatches
6. 500 Internal Server Error debugging
7. Package dependency verification

Server Status

Item	Status
Node Server	Running Successfully
MongoDB Connection	Connected
Environment Variables	Loaded Successfully
Authentication APIs	Partially Tested

4. Work in Progress

4.1 Frontend and Backend Integration

The current active task is aligning the frontend React application with backend APIs.

Ongoing tasks:

1. Connecting frontend forms with backend endpoints
2. Handling authentication tokens in frontend
3. Testing protected routes
4. API response handling
5. Error message display implementation
6. Dashboard integration
7. Role-based navigation handling

4.2 Journal Submission Module

The journal submission workflow is currently under development.

Planned functionality:

1. Research paper upload
2. Journal metadata submission
3. Author profile management
4. Submission tracking
5. Review assignment workflow
6. Publication status updates

5. Remaining Work

Task	Details	Depends On
Complete frontend integration	Connect all React pages with backend APIs	API testing
File upload module	Integrate Cloudinary for document uploads	Backend integration
Reviewer module	Add review assignment and review submission workflows	Authentication
Admin dashboard	Manage users, journals, and submissions	Backend completion
Testing	End-to-end testing of complete workflow	All modules
Deployment	Deploy frontend and backend applications	Integration complete
Final documentation	Prepare SRS updates, user manual, and final report	System completion

6. Weekly Development Timeline

6.1 Weekly Task Breakdown

Day	Task	Status
Monday	Reviewed frontend and backend repositories	Complete
Tuesday	Configured MongoDB Atlas connection	Complete
Wednesday	Tested authentication APIs	Complete
Thursday	Configured Cloudinary integration	Complete

Day	Task	Status
Friday	Debugged server and API issues	In Progress
Saturday	Started frontend-backend integration	In Progress
Sunday	Reviewed deployment preparation requirements	Pending

6.2 Development Phase Timeline

Phase	Task	Timeline	Status
Phase 1	Proposal and planning	December 2025	Complete
Phase 2	ML model training and Flask API	January — February 2026	Complete
Phase 2	SRS documentation	January 2026	Complete
Phase 3	React Native mobile app	March — April 2026	In Progress
Phase 4	Node.js backend development	April — May 2026	Pending
Phase 5	Hardware integration (ESP32-CAM + pump)	May 2026	Pending
Phase 6	System integration and testing	May — June 2026	Pending
Phase 7	Final documentation and submission	June 2026	Pending

7. Technical Stack Technical Stack

Component	Technology	Purpose
Frontend	React.js	User Interface
Backend	Node.js + Express.js	Server-side APIs
Database	MongoDB Atlas	Data Storage
Authentication	JWT	Secure User Access
File Uploads	Cloudinary	Document Management
API Testing	Postman	Endpoint Testing
Version Control	GitHub	Source Code Management
Package Manager	npm	Dependency Management

8. Challenges Faced

The following challenges were encountered during this reporting period:

1. MongoDB connection issues caused by incorrect environment variables
2. JWT authentication and token verification errors
3. Backend API route mismatches with frontend requests
4. Internal server errors during authentication testing
5. Dependency and package configuration problems

Solutions were implemented through debugging, environment configuration correction, and API testing.

9. Next Week Plan

Planned tasks for the next development cycle:

1. Complete frontend-backend API integration
 2. Implement full journal submission workflow
 3. Add secure file upload support
 4. Complete reviewer dashboard
 5. Test authentication and authorization flows
 6. Prepare deployment configuration
 7. Start complete system testing
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Supervisor's Remarks

Remarks:

Signature:

Supervisor Name Department of Software Engineering Government College University Faisalabad

Date:
